
TASK 2: PHISHING AWARENESS TRAINING

CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS

AN INTERACTIVE GUIDE ON ANALYZING
SOCIAL ENGINEERING VECTORS,
IDENTIFYING DECEPTIVE THREATS, AND
EXECUTING SAFETY PROTOCOLS.

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01. WHAT IS PHISHING?



"Phishing is a deceptive technique used by cybercriminals to trick individuals into revealing sensitive information—such as passwords, credit card numbers, or corporate credentials.

Rather than exploiting technical software bugs, phishing exploits human psychology (like trust, urgency, or curiosity) to bypass security controls."



02. SOCIAL ENGINEERING PSYCHOLOGICAL TRIGGERS

- **Urgency:**

Creating a false sense of time pressure (e.g., 'Account suspended in 24 hours') to bypass logical thinking and panic the victim into acting quickly.

- **Authority:**

Impersonating executives, company leadership, or IT support to demand immediate compliance, money transfers, or password disclosures.

- **Fear & Greed:**

Using intimidation (threat of account termination, legal actions) or promising fake rewards (gift cards, bonuses) to exploit extreme emotional reactions.

03. RECOGNIZING THREATS

HOW TO SPOT A PHISHING EMAIL

- Sender Mismatch:**

Check the actual email address, not just the display name. Attackers often use slight misspellings (e.g., 'microso0ft.com' instead of 'microsoft.com')

- Urgent Tone:**

Legitimate companies rarely demand immediate action under threat of account suspension or legal action."

- Suspicious Links:**

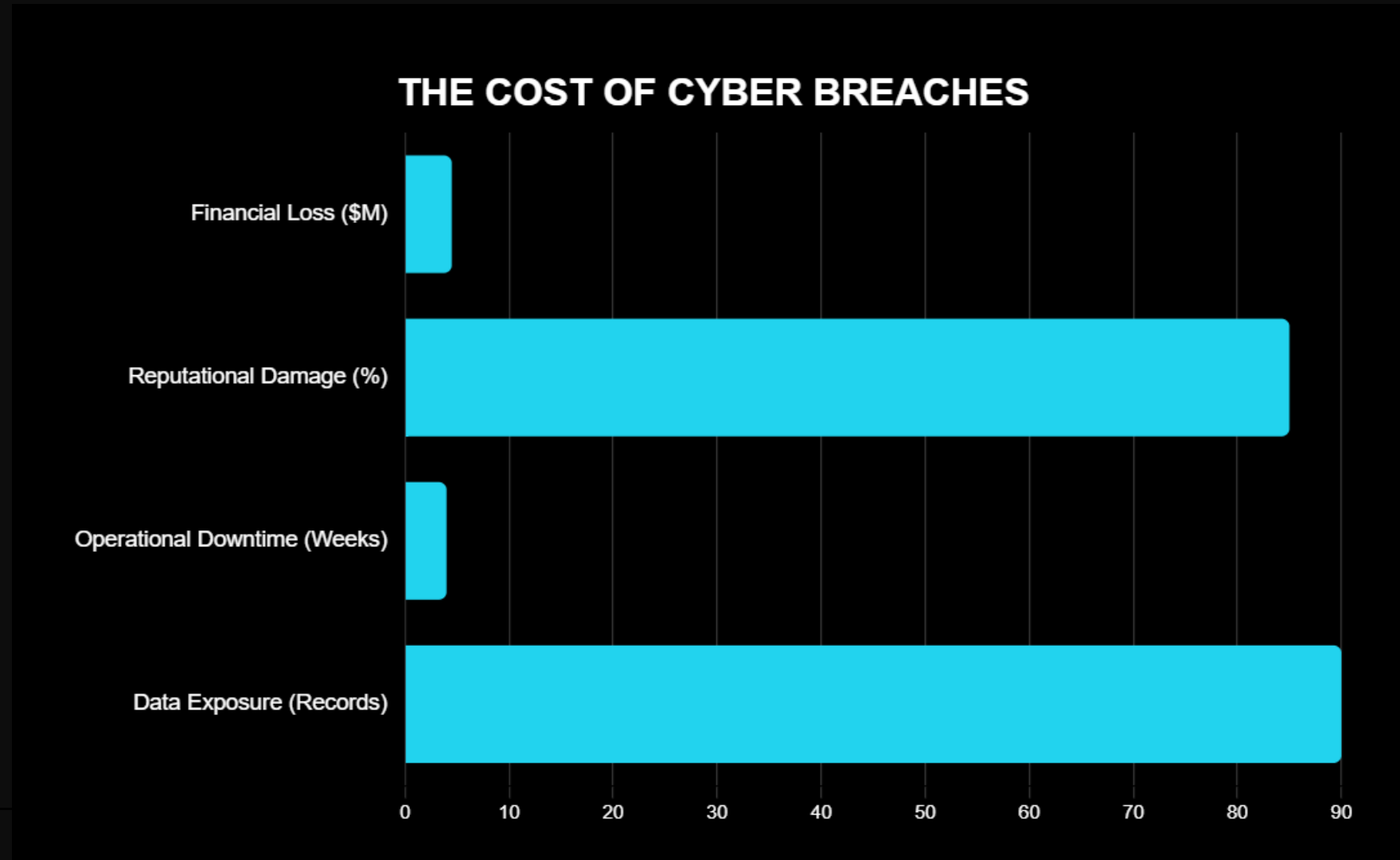
Always hover over links before clicking. If the destination URL looks strange or doesn't match the sender, do not click it.

- Generic Salutations:**

Emails addressed to 'Valued Customer' or 'Dear User' instead of your name are common red flags.



04. REAL-WORLD IMPACT



TEST YOUR KNOWLEDGE

Question 1: If you receive an urgent email from a known service provider demanding an immediate password reset, what should you do first?

- A) Click the provided link to reset it immediately.
- B) Check the sender's email address for inconsistencies or misspellings.
- C) Forward the email to all your contacts.

Question 2: What is the purpose of Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)?

- A) To make logging in more difficult.
- B) To provide an extra layer of security that protects accounts even if a password is compromised.
- C) To automatically delete phishing emails.



Key Takeaways

- Phishing is a human-centric threat that exploits psychology.
- Always verify sender addresses and hover over links before clicking
- Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) as your primary line of defense.
- Stay skeptical—legitimate organizations will never threaten you with immediate account suspension.



THANK YOU



FOR YOUR ATTENTION!

Stay Vigilant, Stay Secure.